

FILM REVIEWS

LUCK BY CHANCE

Guts and Glitter

RATING ★ ★ ★ ★ ☆

Director: Zoya Akhtar**Starring:** Farhan Akhtar, Konkona Sen Sharma

A colour scheme is very important for a performance, says the outsider (Farhan Akhtar) to the star kid (Isha Sharvani). She's being earnest. He's being sarcastic. *Luck by Chance* is full of these perfectly pitched encounters between old and new, young and established, have-nots and want-it-alls. Rommy Rolly (Rishi Kapoor, brilliant) calls the



star mom (Dimple Kapadia) a crocodile in a chiffon sari. The writer (Anurag Kashyap) tells Rolly, "But I wrote the script according to the DVD, just as I was asked." "I don't work for myself. I work for an icon," says the star (Hrithik Roshan) to his

reflection. Beautifully written, acutely observed and sensitively directed by Zoya Akhtar, the movie tells several tales from Bollywood without becoming an exposé. The junior artiste (Konkona Sen Sharma) ends up with a fridge she won in a contest.

The man she dated before he became a star gets the glossy covers, the girls and the glamour. Several stars play themselves, sometimes wise, other times witty. Insider insights, outsider detachment. The movie has it all.

by Kaveree Bamzai

DEV.D

Doom, Not Gloom

RATING ★ ★ ★ ★ ☆

Director: Anurag Kashyap**Starring:** Abhay Deol, Kalki Koechlin

An utterly swinish young man with pots of money smokes pot, gets drunk and strips naked, sometimes all at once. This is a modern Devdas, or Devinder Singh Dhillon, with his own BMW accident. He has a Paro, Parminder, who marries an older man with kids. He also has a

Chanda, a prostitute with an MMS scandal in her recent past. "You're such a slut," says Chanda (Koechlin) to the love of her life, Dev. D, played by Deol. "In Delhi, you can kill a cat, eat a cat, but you can't domesticate a cat," says the small-time pimp of various white-skinned ladies of the night to his biggest client Dev. Kashyap brings pathos to what seems like a doomed love affair between Dev and Chanda, she bathing him in a giant *balti* and painting him as a sad clown. Delhi's grim underbelly, with its coke-fuelled private parties, its fetish for white women, and its rich kids with expensive toys, comes alive in Kashyap's vibrant frames, dotted with Savita Bhabhi comic strips and kitschy pop art. There's doom, but no gloom.

-KB



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